

THANDOKAZI NOMVELO PHUNZANA

Computer Science & Information Technology Graduate

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Motivated and detail-oriented Computer Science & Information Technology graduate from the University of KwaZulu-Natal with strong foundations in software engineering, object-oriented programming, data structures, and database systems. Hands-on experience developing applications across Python, Java, C++, C#, SQL, and Unity. Proven communication, tutoring, and technical leadership abilities gained through academic mentoring roles. Eager to leverage technical expertise in a Junior Software Developer or IT Graduate role to contribute to impactful software solutions.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science & Information Technology Completed: Dec 2025
University of KwaZulu-Natal (UKZN)

Major: Computer Science

National Senior Certificate (Matric) Completed: Dec 2021
Mbopha High School, KwaZulu-Natal

Achieved 4 Distinctions | 80% Academic Average

TECHNICAL & CORE SKILLS

Programming Languages	Python, Java, C++, C#, SQL, JavaScript
Software Development	Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Data Structures & Algorithms, REST APIs, .NET Fundamentals, NLP Principles, Debugging & Troubleshooting, Version Control
Databases	MySQL, Relational Database Design, Complex SQL Queries, Data Normalization
Game & Web Development	Unity Engine (C#), 3D Game Mechanics, HTML5, CSS3
Developer Tools	Git, GitHub, Visual Studio, NetBeans, Google Colab, VS Code
Soft Skills	Problem Solving, Technical Communication, Team Collaboration, Time Management, Attention to Detail, Organizational Skills, Work Under Pressure, Adaptability

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

3D Game Development Project Unity, C#

- Designed and implemented interactive gameplay mechanics using C# scripting and Unity engine components.
- Applied Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) principles to structure player movement, scoring systems, and state management.
- Debugged runtime performance bottlenecks and optimized physics rendering for fluid 60fps gameplay.
- Constructed immersive 3D game environments featuring dynamic enemy AI interactions and collision detection.

Chatbot Development Project Python, NLP

- Built a responsive rule-based conversational chatbot utilizing Python and Natural Language Processing concepts.
- Implemented text preprocessing pipelines, including tokenization, lowercasing, and keyword matching logic.
- Tested, evaluated, and refined intent-matching algorithms to improve response accuracy and overall user interaction.
- Utilized Google Colab for interactive development, debugging, and execution testing.

Natural Language Processing (NLP) Text Analytics Python, NLTK, Pandas

- Applied text mining and NLP techniques to clean, transform, and analyze unstructured textual datasets.
- Executed data preprocessing operations including stop-word removal, lemmatization, and vectorization to improve analysis quality.
- Extracted actionable statistical insights and generated data visualizations to support model evaluation.

Interactive Quiz Game Application

C++

- Engineered a robust, console-based interactive quiz application utilizing modular C++ architecture.
- Implemented control flow structures, custom functions, scoring algorithms, and robust user input validation.
- Utilized object-oriented and modular programming techniques to elevate code reusability and maintainability.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Academic Tutor — University of KwaZulu-Natal (UKZN)

Durban, South Africa

Module: Data Structures | Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

- Facilitated practical lab sessions for 2nd-year students covering core algorithms, abstract data types, and Big-O complexity.
- Guided students through hands-on implementation of trees, graphs, sorting algorithms, and memory management in C++/Java.
- Evaluated coursework and provided constructive technical feedback to reinforce software engineering principles.

Module: Computer Organization & Architecture | Sep 2024 – Nov 2024

- Tutored 2nd-year students on low-level architecture, assembly language execution, CPU cycles, and network protocols.
- Explained practical implementation of memory hierarchies, registers, and instruction set architectures.
- Assisted students in troubleshooting assembly routines and preparing for practical laboratory assessments.

Module: Introduction to Programming | Mar 2024 – May 2024

- Mentored 1st-year students in Python programming fundamentals, logical problem-solving, and algorithmic thinking.
- Conducted one-on-one and group code reviews, teaching effective debugging techniques and clean code practices.
- Supported students through programming assignments, significantly improving pass rates and technical confidence.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Seeking Junior Developer / Graduate IT Roles

Available for Relocation

Passionate about Software Development & Problem Solving